

COLUMBIA

I would describe an ideal Columbia essay as:

- **Profoundly intellectual (deep)**
- **Boldly challenging norms**
- **Strategically controversial**
- **Witty**
- **Varied in references (has references from all over the world; references should be all-round, i.e., encompassing both the Sciences and Humanities)**

Hacks

- **Columbia loves social "traumas"— traumatic experiences that you experienced either first-hand or vicariously, which are provoked by *complex* social issues.**
- **Globalmindedness/internationalism goes a long way. Being that Columbia has 9 (soon to be 10) Global Centers all over the world, this card is essential.**
- **The African card in tandem with the Global Citizen card work perfectly.**
- **The Diversity Card: showcasing an all-welcoming attitude, including but not limited to allyship and feminism.**
- **Having at least one *significant* international activity is a plus.**
- **Spiking should ideally be done in every piece of writing (PSs, LORs, etc.)**

Notes

Columbia essays are biased toward seasoned creative writers. Anyone who is a good creative writer stands significantly higher chances of being admitted.